

RAWAN ALADDIN



Designer — brand systems, digital and campaign production, and motion

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Best Buy Canada • Junior Digital Designer • Digital Retail Design • R-53210

Dear Digital Retail Design team,

The day I looked, your English homepage said “Pro further.” The French one said “Professionniste.” It does not translate the line; it rebuilds the joke. A few inches down the dollar sign has moved to the other side of the number, and a pre-order that opens at 5:00 a.m. PT opens at 8 h (HE). That is one offer built twice, and neither version is allowed to look like the other's leftovers.

That is the problem I have spent this year inside. SyriaTek is an Arabic-language technology series I make for Syrians inside the country and across the diaspora — people who use a smartphone every day and were never handed the rest of it. I designed the identity in two languages, an Arabic wordmark and an English one built to sit together without either looking like a translation of the other, and then cut the profile art, the cover and the animated mark again for each platform's own crop. I filmed the presenter takes and twenty-one B-roll clips in Syria, cut both pilots vertical, and subtitled them in both languages. It is still running.

Underneath that is a habit I built on a different project. Feeds is a self-hosted reader for security analysts, and the client was the engineer building it. I authored the identity and then the eleven-page system beneath it: three lockups and four explicit don'ts, five colours each carrying the proportion of a page it should occupy, a five-step type scale named for what each step is for, fifteen icons drawn to one grammar, an AA contrast floor. And then I had to obey it — across the product interface, the digest email, the marketing site, and a launch booth with printed table runners and die-cut stickers in four colourways. The engine is his; everything you can see is mine.

So the discipline this role describes is one I have practised from both ends of it. Writing a rulebook is what taught me where the room in one is. It fixes the typeface and the colour, and it leaves the crop, the pacing of a banner and the weight of a headline wide open. That is where a promotional tile stops looking like a template someone filled in.

You ask for motion fundamentals, so here is mine at its smallest. The page transition on my own site is artwork I drew in Lottie, redrawn as four SVG paths and animated in CSS: about two kilobytes, no animation library, two duration tokens, one easing curve, and a thirty-four millisecond stagger between the strokes. It disappears for anyone who has asked their machine for reduced motion. Lightweight was the whole brief.

What draws me to this desk is that retail design gets judged by somebody who is not admiring it. They are deciding whether to spend real money before the sale ends, on a phone, with the legal footnote and the price in the same glance. Every element on the page is answerable to that moment, and that is the standard I would bring to the work. I am in the Vancouver area, the in-person days suit me, and I would welcome the chance to talk it through.

Sincerely,

Rawan Aladdin